

SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

December 2025 – January 2026 Analysis

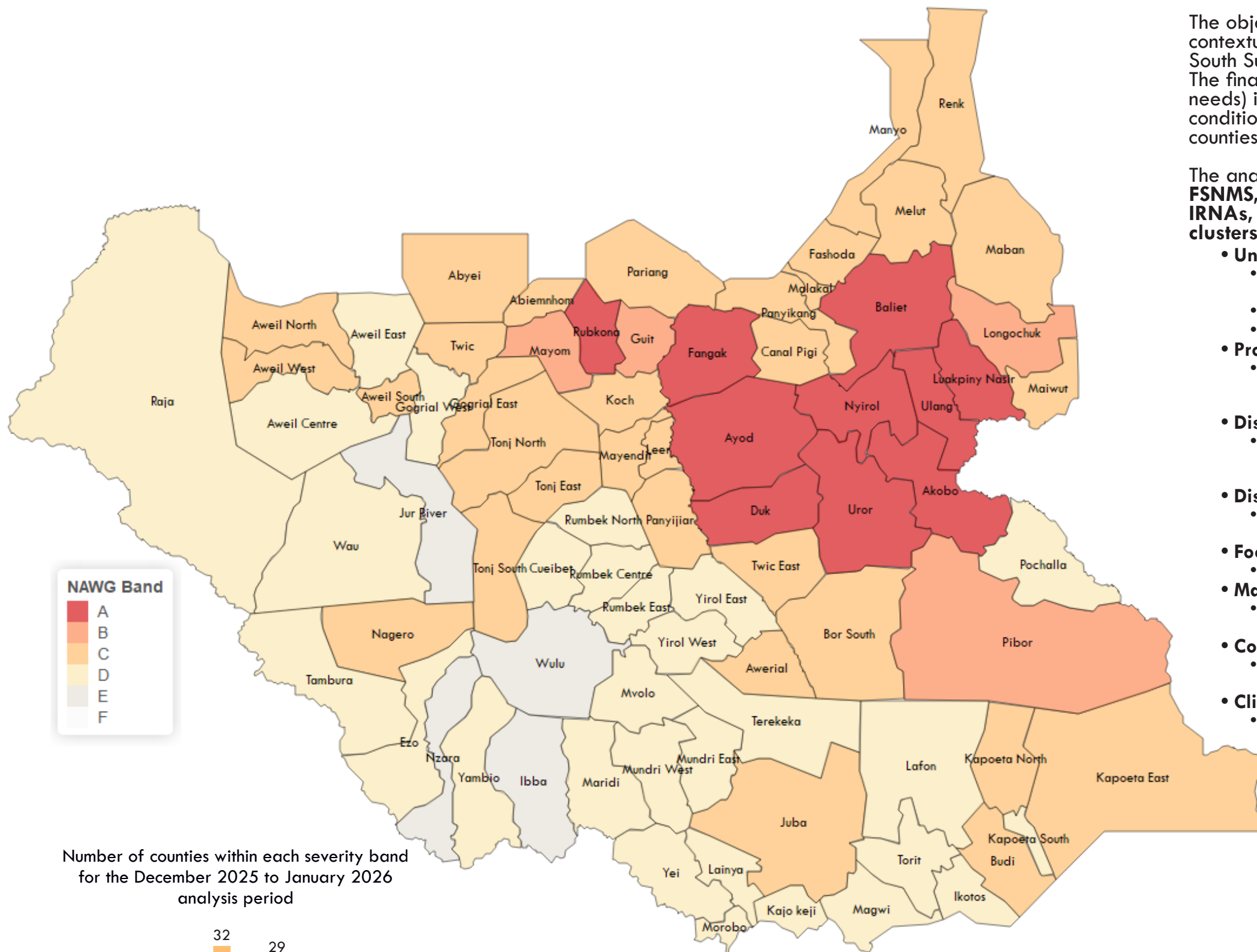
Background

The NAWG meeting was held on February 17, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **December 2025 to January 2026** period.

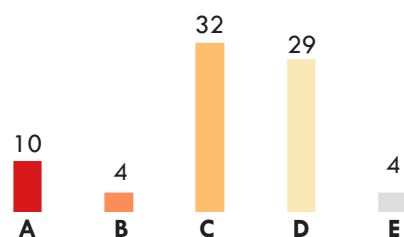
The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
 - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
 - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rain anomalies.



Number of counties within each severity band
for the December 2025 to January 2026
analysis period



Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B	7 - 7.9	Very severe humanitarian conditions
C	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions
D	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
E	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
F	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

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The December 2025 - January 2026 NAWG analysis marks the first cycle under the revised analytical framework. The most significant development this cycle is a sharp increase in Band A (Extreme humanitarian conditions) counties from 4 in the November-December 2025 analysis to 10. This is driven overwhelmingly by the escalation of armed conflict in Jonglei State that began in late December 2025.

The conflict in Jonglei has reportedly displaced nearly 280,000 people across Uror, Nyirol, Akobo, Duk, Ayod, Canal/Pigi, Twic East, and Bor South, with secondary displacement into Upper Nile and Lakes states. Humanitarian access was severely restricted by a declared no-fly zone and restrictions on road movement, cutting off critical supply routes and forcing the evacuation of aid workers. The Joint Verification and Monitoring Mechanism (JVMM) confirmed on 15 February that humanitarian personnel are authorized to resume travel to previously restricted locations, effective 16 February.

[FEWS NET](#) assessed “that the risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) has expanded to additional areas of north-central Jonglei and Upper Nile, encompassing Nasir, Ulang, Ayod, Duk, Nyirol, Uror, Akobo, and Fangak.” They note that “these areas are already experiencing high levels of hunger and acute malnutrition, with several counties – including Duk, Ulang, and Nasir – projected to surpass Extremely Critical levels of acute malnutrition, particularly as cholera outbreaks re-emerge. If conflict escalates such that it isolates populations and prevents access to local food sources and humanitarian assistance for a prolonged period, then Famine (IPC Phase 5) would likely occur”.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Ten counties were classified as having **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)** during this analysis period. These counties are **Ulang, Nasir, Rubkona, Fangak, Duk, Baliet, Uror, Nyirol, Akobo, and Ayod**.

Most of these counties are located in Jonglei and Upper Nile and are facing compounded challenges, including ongoing conflict, high protection risks, significant population displacement, and severe disease burdens.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Uror:** Uror was the epicentre of the conflict escalation that began in late December 2025. ACLED recorded 19 conflict events and 96 fatalities in the county during December-January – the highest in the country – including 10 airstrikes. As of early February, an estimated 105,427 people had been displaced.

The closure of 24 nutrition sites across Uror and Nyirol cut off 7,868 children from care, including 2,633 with severe acute malnutrition, and 2,764 pregnant and breastfeeding women. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**

- **Nyirol:** Flagged due to intensified fighting and airstrikes causing civilian harm, facility damage, large-scale displacement, and a no-fly zone restricting humanitarian access. ACLED recorded 11 events and 55 fatalities (including 5 airstrikes). Lankien health facility was reportedly damaged while over 120 patients were inside, forcing closure; roughly 57,195 were displaced and humanitarian assets were looted/confiscated. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Akobo:** Flagged due to extreme displacement pressure and disrupted life-saving response under continued insecurity and movement restrictions. As of 17 Feb, 40,000+ arrivals reached Akobo town from Lankien, with over 82,000 displaced across the county. Limited supplies (2.5 MT) were delivered on 2 Feb but the needs are expected to outpace the response. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Ayod:** Flagged due to escalating insecurity compounded by cholera resurgence, displacement inflows, and interference affecting humanitarian operations. Ayod has become a major receiving area for populations fleeing Uror and Nyirol, with 17,025 people displaced into the county. On 21 January, reports of an imminent attack triggered panic and looting in Ayod Town. Cholera resurged with 64 cases and 17 deaths in the two weeks ending 15 Feb, while programme suspensions affected roughly 85,000 beneficiaries. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Pibor:** Flagged due to elevated violence against civilians, though access and operations remain relatively stable. ACLED recorded 12 events and 15 fatalities, including 6 incidents of violence against civilians; clashes and convoy insecurity were noted. Partners remain operational as the road conditions have improved. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B, added to close monitoring.**
- **Awerial:** Flagged due to sustained displacement into Minkaman straining already severe food insecurity and malnutrition context. Arrivals from northern Jonglei reached 29,500 registered by mid-February, adding pressure on services and host communities. Response is ongoing. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C, added to close monitoring.**
- **Rumbek North:** Flagged due to worsening inter-communal violence and deteriorating road security amid political transition risk. ACLED recorded 6 events and 10 fatalities (including 4 incidents of violence against civilians), with January attacks and retaliatory clashes reported around the Rumbek–Maper Road. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**

- **Morobo:** Flagged due to high conflict intensity outside Jonglei and risks to civilians, displacement, and humanitarian operations. ACLED recorded 13 events and 23 fatalities; attacks along the Yei–Morobo–Kaya corridor and opposition activity around Panyume were reported, including coercive resource extraction and localized displacement. Cross-border dynamics (DRC) raise continued risk through the dry season. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**
- **Tonj East:** Flagged due to persistent civilian targeting and revenge-cycle violence, with cross-state cattle raiding as an aggravating factor. ACLED recorded 7 events and 38 fatalities (including 5 incidents of violence against civilians), alongside raid-related tensions and retaliation risks. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Ezo:** Flagged due to large-scale displacement and credible risk of renewed fighting ahead of the rainy season. Conflict-related displacement affected over 30,000 people last year; reports suggest armed elements are resupplying and reorganising, with a likely deterioration before April. Humanitarian assistance is ongoing but the risk profile remains high for an already displaced population. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.

- **Fangak (Band A):** Continued monitoring due to extreme flooding affecting 150,000 people and IPC analysis projecting catastrophic food insecurity for 5% of the population.
- **Nasir (Band A):** Remains under watch due to projected catastrophic food insecurity (5% of the population), IPC AMN Phase 5 classification, a non-functional main hospital since March 2025, and restricted civilian access under military occupation.
- **Rubkona (Band A):** Continued monitoring due to IPC AMN Phase 5 classification, clashes causing 24,600 displaced, looted nutrition supplies, militarisation of humanitarian facilities.
- **Baliet (Band A):** Flagged due to 1,546.6 MT of supplies being looted, illegal taxation disrupting the Sobat corridor, and extremely critical levels of malnutrition.
- **Longochuk, Kapoeta East, Manyo, Renk, Bor South, Pibor, and Awerial (Bands B–C)** are also to be monitored due to displacement inflows, deteriorating malnutrition/WASH conditions, and increasing operational interference.